

Chapter 2: Time-Independent Schrödinger Equation

Quantum Mechanics — Quick Reference

1 Momentum Operator

Definition 1.1 (Momentum Operator (Position Representation)). [def:momentum-operator-position] In one dimension, the momentum operator $\hat{p}$ acts on a position-space wavefunction $\psi(x)$ as

$$\hat{p}\psi(x) = -i\hbar \frac{d\psi}{dx}(x),$$

or equivalently, as a differential operator,

$$\hat{p} = -i\hbar \frac{d}{dx}.$$

In three dimensions, $\hat{\vec{p}} = -i\hbar \nabla$.